RDS doesn’t delete manual snapshots automatically; you need to delete them yourself if you don’t need them any longer. You’ll learn how to do this at the end of the section.

Copying an automated snapshot as a manual snapshot

There is a difference between automated and manual snapshots. Automated snapshots are deleted automatically after the retention period is over, but manual snapshots aren’t. If you want to keep an automated snapshot even after the retention period is over, you have to copy the automated snapshot to a new manual snapshot.

Get the snapshot identifier of an automated snapshot from the RDS database you started in section 10.1 by running the following command at your local terminal. Replace `$DBInstanceIdentifier` with the output of the `describe-db-instances` command:

```
$ aws rds describe-db-snapshots --snapshot-type automated \
➥ --db-instance-identifier $DBInstanceIdentifier \
➥ --query "DBSnapshots[0].DBSnapshotIdentifier" \
➥ --output text
```

The next command copies an automated snapshot to a manual snapshot named `wordpress-copy-snapshot`. Replace `$SnapshotId` with the output from the previous command:

```
$ aws rds copy-db-snapshot \
➥ --source-db-snapshot-identifier $SnapshotId  \
➥ --target-db-snapshot-identifier wordpress-copy-snapshot
```

The copy of the automated snapshot is named `wordpress-copy-snapshot`. It won’t be removed automatically.